[METRIC]
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Superseding
A-A-41
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COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SODIUM CARBONATE, ANHYDROUS

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description, for all federal agencies.

1. Scope. This commercial item description covers two types of sodium carbonate intended for various washing processes, with or without soap as conditions may require, when a moderately strong alkaline material is required, and for the treatment of water.

2. Types and classes.

Type I - Light
Type II - Dense

3. Salient Characteristics:

3.1 Material. The sodium carbonate shall be a white, crystalline solid and shall conform to the physical and chemical requirements of Table I when tested as specified in ASTM D 501 (applicable sections listed).

TABLE I. Chemical and physical characteristics.

Characteristic		ASTM D 501 Sections
Loss on heating, maximum percent by weight	1.0	18, 19
Water insoluble matter in dried material, max. percent by weight	0.25	29, 30

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarification, etc., and any data which may improve this document, should be sent to: GSA, Paints and Chemicals Center, 400 15th Street, S.W., Auburn, WA 98001.

FSC 6810

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TABLE 1 (continued)

Characteristic		ASTM D 501 Section
Total alkalinity in dried material, minimum percent by weight	99.2	20, 21, 22
Apparent density, pounds per cubic foot, (Type I).	29 to 37	31, 32
Apparent density, pounds per cubic foot, (Type II).	42 to 70	31, 32

NOTE: The contractor may use his normal quality assurance procedures for manufacture of this product; however, should a disagreement arise between the Government and its customer or between the Government and the manufacturer concerning compliance to the salient characteristics of this commercial item description, the test methods and tests stated in this commercial item description will be used to determine compliance of the product.

3. Product Conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

ASTM standards are available from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 100 Barr Harbor Drive, West Conshohocken, PA 19428-2959.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:
GSA - FSS

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